



Call the PC doctor for Windows 8

rom a user interface perspective, Windows 8 is less than ideal. And no, these aren't just rants from one unhappy customer, this is a sentiment expressed and underlined by thousands of people, reviewers, independent analysts who've tried out Microsoft's latest operating system. Microsoft made wholesale user interface changes to Vista's look and feel by introducing a whole new Start screen that would really give even the most loyal of Windows fan a serious amount of headache. Sure, live tiles are good to look at and they aren't completely useless, but then why is a Windows 8 forced to live with it? Microsoft never really explained their stance on enforcing the new Start screen on millions of Windows users used to working with it in a certain way, and completely doing away with the Start button in the process as well. That was an unpardonable sin, why Microsoft, why?! A lot of software

hacks were available after Windows 8's release to correct the wrong, and give people some semblance of familiarity with Windows 8's bold new landscape. After a lot of angst and public outcry against the termination of the much-beloved and convenient Start button in Windows 8, there's increasing evidence that Microsoft's going to bring it back in the next avatar of Windows scheduled to launch sooner than you expect.

While we are no user interface or design critics, but a noticeable flaw in Windows 8's user interface is that everything looks flat and visual cues noticeable in past flavours of Windows operating systems have either been toned down or slashed out completely. Allow us to explain: For years on Windows / Mac and Linux, buttons are designed to look like buttons. There's a drop shadow, or a bevelled look, something. Windows 8 has plain text. You can't tell what's meant to be clicked, and what's not. And we're also hoping that Windows Blue



No more Start button. Boo hoo!

or Windows 8.1 as it's officially called will bring back the intuition, instead of just expecting people to get used to Windows 8's warped UI. Just doing something new and fancy for the sake of freshening things up doesn't necessarily work, as Windows 8 has demonstrated with its Modern UI, unfortunately.

Also there's this perception about Windows 8 that it's actually an amalgamation of two separate OSes – a desktop and mobile OS mashup, if you will. Microsoft, some believe, is trying to please everyone by mixing and matching the touch and mouse interfaces for mobile / tablet users and us poor PC chaps, and failing miserably at doing both. Although you may be cribbing about it now, you will soon get used to it... ask yourself how averse will you be to a tablet or phone that throws up the same UI in, say, two years?

While Microsoft knows better, we still feel it's a mistake to take PC users for granted, even if the PC's being redefined in our age. Why? Because we still need to work, and that's still a bit of a stretch on a smartphone or tablet alone. In its attempt to get you used to the UIs of their consumption devices, Microsoft is messing with your productivity.



The whole new Start screen with Modern UI brings in a steep learning curve